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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **A judge rejected** the Justice Department's request to dismantle Google's online advertising business, the second time a court has denied government efforts to break up the company after it was found liable for engaging in illegal monopoly tactics. **A1**
- ◆ **Chevron, ENI and other** energy companies signed deals in Caracas to plow billions of dollars into Venezuela's oil fields following months of tense negotiations. **B1**
- ◆ **As clouds over the** bond market continued to stress investors, U.S. stocks rose, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq both gaining 0.5% and the Dow adding 0.6%. **B10**
- ◆ **Ford aims to sell** more than 100,000 new electric trucks in their first year of production, vehicles designed to compete with Tesla and Chinese makers. **B3**
- ◆ **More victims of the** Tumbler Ridge massacre sued OpenAI over its failure to alert police about ChatGPT interactions with the suspect months before the February mass shooting in Canada. **B1**
- ◆ **Wonderful, a startup** that helps large enterprises deploy artificial intelligence, raised \$550 million at a \$5 billion valuation to fund a worldwide hiring spree. **B4**
- ◆ **Blackstone led a** \$27 million investment in Huskeys, a cybersecurity startup building a gatekeeper to protect clients from unwanted artificial-intelligence traffic. **B4**
- ◆ **Southwest Airlines** will open airport lounges in four American cities, hoping to lure fliers to a new high-end credit card it plans to launch next year. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Steve Bannon**, Trump's former chief strategist, joined Democrats in warning about the dangers of artificial intelligence and the need to fight data centers powering AI deployment. **A1**
- ◆ **Tech executives** and government officials urged policymakers from other leading economies to minimize AI regulations, arguing that strict rules could strangle an industry capable of supercharging global growth and curing diseases. **A4**
- ◆ **The U.S. government** filed a statement supporting OpenAI in its legal battle with publishers, arguing that training on news content falls under fair use in U.S. copyright law. **A4**
- ◆ **Defense Secretary Pete** Hegseth is extending troop deployments that signal the war with Iran could be prolonged into the new year. **A7**
- ◆ **A plane carrying** Homeland Security Secretary Markwayne Mullin made an emergency landing at Washington's Reagan National Airport. **A3**
- ◆ **Special forces from** Israel's Shin Bet security service seized a senior Hamas official near his home in Gaza and spirited him across the border into Israel for interrogation. **A9**
- ◆ **Tiger Woods pleaded** no contest to a reckless driving charge and his driver's license was suspended for five years following a March SUV crash in Florida. **A6**
- ◆ **Chinese leader Xi** Jinping began a state visit to Egypt that aims to reinforce Beijing's ties with an important ally of the U.S. in the Middle East. **A7**
- ◆ **Died: Cassandra Wilson**, 70, Grammy-winning jazz singer. **A6**

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After 286 Days at Sea, Lincoln Sailors Get a Break



ON THE TOWN: Sailors pose with a python Wednesday in Pattaya, Thailand, after the USS Abraham Lincoln, which spent months supporting U.S. operations against Iran, docked. Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth is extending deployments to the Middle East. **A7**

Volkswagen Survival Plan Pits CEO Against His Own Board

By STEPHEN WILMOT

When Volkswagen Chief Executive Oliver Blume took a cost-cutting plan to his board this summer that envisioned a doubling of job losses to 100,000, he was fully aware it would be rejected. Such is the predicament of running Germany's premier industrial company, where half the supervisory-board directors are worker representatives and swing votes are held by the local government. Now Blume is considering an audacious workaround, ac-

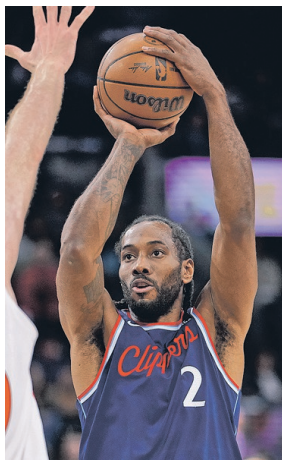
cording to people familiar with his plans. If the board factions can't come to an agreement at a meeting set to take place on Friday, he could go hostile—by-passing the board like an activist investor or corporate raider by taking the plan directly to shareholders. It's a nuclear option, a move without precedent at Volkswagen or the broader German corporate scene, where for years stakeholder capitalism has meant that decisions are driven by consensus among workers, regulators and shareholders.

The stakes are enormous. Chinese automakers are moving headlong onto German carmakers' home turf after dethroning them in China, previously their strongest overseas market. Higher U.S. tariffs under President Trump and a bumpy transition to electric vehicles and hybrids have cost automakers billions of dollars. "Tariffs, new competitors and geopolitical risks: The entire automotive industry is under enormous pressure," Blume told employees last week. Germany for decades has staved off the kind of deindus-

trialization that has wiped out millions of U.S. manufacturing jobs, maintaining a generation of well paid, skilled workers, particularly in the auto industry. Now "Detroit-ization" is a buzzword in the German media. No German automaker is more affected by the industry turmoil than Volkswagen, which competes head-on with mass-market Chinese brands such as BYD and doesn't have *Please turn to page A9*

◆ **Ford sets lofty EV truck goal**..... **B3**

INSIDE



SPORTS
NBA gives Clippers stiff penalty over payments to Kawhi Leonard. **A16**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Labels can be confusing: Your nonalcoholic beer may have some alcohol. **B1**

Ire Over AI Build-Out Makes Strange Political Bedfellows

WASHINGTON—Steve Bannon has made a career out of clashing with far-left politicians. But these days, President Trump's former chief strategist has found a common cause with them: opposition to the AI boom. *By Amrith Ramkumar, Eliza Collins and Anthony DeBarros* The far-right podcast host has joined Democrats in warning about the dangers of artificial intelligence and the need to fight data centers that power AI deployment. Bannon backs a proposal from Sen. Bernie Sanders (I,

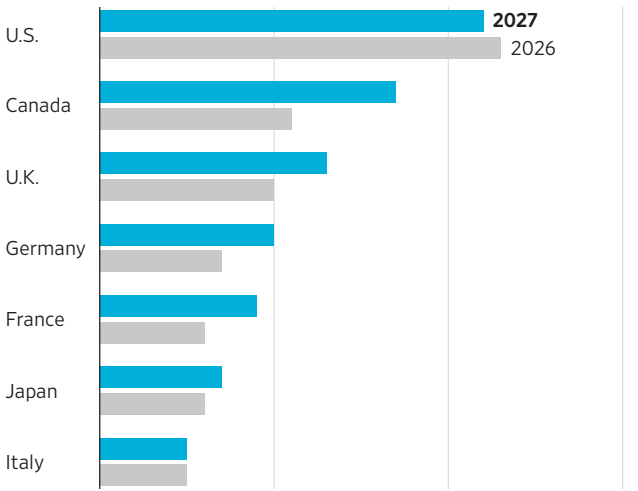
Vt.) and Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez (D., N.Y.) to ban the construction of new data centers. He has rallied grassroots support to fight the Trump administration's efforts to deploy an industry-friendly AI strategy that bans states from passing their own regulations and backs Sanders's recent call for AI companies to pause development. The positions put him squarely at odds with his former boss. "The only reason that communities throughout the U.S.A. should not want Data Centers is if they want to end up being backwards and poor," the president said on social media Monday.

Bannon said he was looking past his disagreements with progressives on issues such as immigration because AI will be the defining issue of the future. "If we don't get this right, none of that other stuff is going to matter," Bannon, who previously received a pardon from Trump, said in an interview. "I have not seen any issue in modern American life at *Please turn to page A4*

- ◆ **Tech CEOs, U.S. urge G-20 to ease AI rules**..... **A4**
- ◆ **New building techniques** speed up data centers.... **B1**
- ◆ **Heard on the Street: Cash—not outrage—to slow AI**... **B11**

As Bond Market Bemoans Debt, Worries Also Mount Over Growth

Real GDP growth, forecast



Source: International Monetary Fund

By JASON DOUGLAS

Here's a surprise about the countries at the center of the bond-market selloff: They're all borrowing far less than Uncle Sam. This year, the International Monetary Fund expects Japan to have the smallest budget deficit in the Group of Seven advanced economies for the third year running, at around 2% of gross domestic product. Excluding interest payments, Italy is headed for a small surplus. The U.K. and France are borrowing more, but the U.S. is in a league of *Please turn to page A2*

◆ **Greg Ip: Bond market gives world leaders an 'F'**..... **A2**

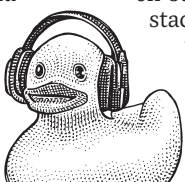
He Was a Washed-Up Pop Star. Now He Sells Out Baby Raves.

Former boy-bander turned techno remixes of nursery rhymes into a global phenomenon

By RACHEL WOLFE

MORRISON, Colo.—The scene at Red Rocks Amphitheatre had all the hallmarks of an electronic dance music festival. Attendees wore holographic bodysuits, went wild when the beat dropped and occasionally spilled their drinks down their shirts. But getting dressed required parental assistance, the bass pulsing off the sandstone was a techno remix of "The Wheels

on the Bus," and the drinks were apple juice and formula. This rave was for toddlers. At the center of the diaphanous frenzy, bouncing around on stage alongside a giant stack of inflatable rings, was Lenny Pearce. Covered in tattoos, with his hair in a long white braid, the 35-year-old Australian DJ and former boy-band member looks more like an all-night raver than a children's host. But he has turned his remixes of clas- *Please turn to page A11*



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